

# Prompting and task execution — Official docs and gold-mine references

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**Pair:** [prompting-task-execution-principles.md](#)

**Course:** Associate · Module 2 · Prompting and Task Execution

**Use this file when:** you need vendor truth, prompt-engineering depth, or primary sources — not for first read of the mechanism.

## How to use this pack

1. Learn the five components, decompose, iterate, and task-type dials from the **principles** pair first.
  2. Open this file for official Anthropic guidance and mechanism-depth blogs.
  3. Prefer the **suggested read order** if time is short.
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## Official product / standard docs

| Link                                                             | What it teaches (mechanism)                                                      | Operator so-what                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">Prompting best practices (Claude Platform)</a>       | Current platform guide: clarity, structure, examples, thinking, agentic patterns | Map course "components" to production prompt sections; re-fetch when models change |
| <a href="#">Prompt engineering overview (docs.anthropic.com)</a> | Official overview of strategies and when to use them                             | Baseline vocabulary for role/instruction/examples vs course component names        |
| <a href="#">Claude 4 prompting best practices</a>                | Explicit instruction needs on newer models ("above and beyond" is not free)      | Tighten task + constraints; do not assume old chatty behavior                      |
| <a href="#">Long context tips</a>                                | Placement and use of large documents in context                                  | Put source material where the model sees it; ties to "context component"           |
| <a href="#">Build with Claude (Anthropic Academy)</a>            | Learning hub into API and practice material                                      | Path from Associate course habits into platform docs                               |

## Gold-mine first-principles sources

| Link                                                                                | Why gold                                                                                                                | Extra tip from that source                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">Effective context engineering for AI agents (Anthropic Engineering)</a> | Separates <b>prompt engineering</b> (instruction craft) from <b>context engineering</b> (what tokens sit in the window) | Course "context component" is the human face of context engineering; system prompts need clear altitude and sections |
| <a href="#">Equipping agents for the real world with Agent Skills</a>               | Skills as reusable procedure packs with progressive disclosure                                                          | When a prompt repeats weekly, promote it to a Skill (Module 1 capability layer), not a longer chat paste             |
| <a href="#">PortSwigger Research</a>                                                | First-principles security writeups with repro                                                                           | For appsec prompts: demand method + evidence format the same way research papers demand method                       |

| Link                                                | Why gold                                                   | Extra tip from that source                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">Simon Willison — LLM / agents posts</a> | Clear mechanism writing on tools, evals, and failure modes | Use "show your intermediate artifact" the same way this course uses decomposition steps |

## Cross-stack / cross-vendor map

| Principle here (Claude course)     | Same idea elsewhere                                                     |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Role + task + constraints + format | System/developer message + user message patterns (OpenAI, Gemini, Grok) |
| Context gaps                       | RAG / project knowledge / memory / @-files — still only what you attach |
| Decomposition                      | Multi-step agent plans, scratchpads, "plan then execute"                |
| Parallel independent legs          | Fan-out subagents / separate chats, then merge                          |
| Iterate one component              | Ablation: change one variable when debugging a model call               |
| Analysis vs brainstorm latitude    | Temperature/sampling is not a substitute for clear constraints          |

## Suggested read order

1. Principles pair (this module) — component stack + decompose + iterate
2. [Prompting best practices](#) — official production habits
3. [Effective context engineering](#) — why context gaps dominate
4. Model-specific best-practices page for the model you actually use (re-fetch; labels move)

## Gaps

| Missing source                                              | Why it matters                              | Status                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Live CPN / Associate module page URL (authenticated course) | Canonical course copy changes               | gap — use your course UI; do not invent quiz answers from memory |
| Module 7 troubleshooting deep link                          | Course points iteration forward to Module 7 | gap until that module is captured                                |

## Do not put here

- Full first-principles re-teach (that is the principles pair)
- Orphan tips with no source row (if critical → principles pair)